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Robot Vacuum Buying Guide 2026: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra Comparison

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If you’re juggling pets, a hectic schedule, and a mix of carpet and hard floors in 2026, picking the right robot vacuum can feel overwhelming.

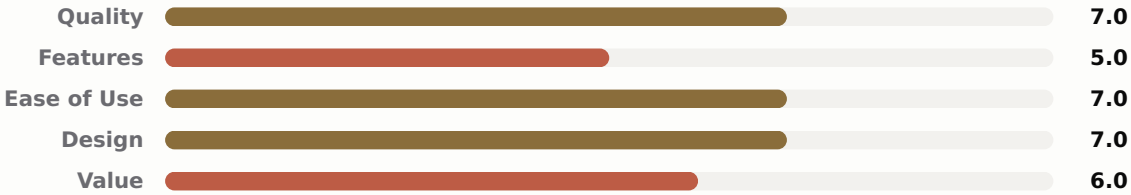
The iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock cuts through the noise—offering strong suction, built-in mopping, and a self-empty base for just $199.99, while the Shark AI Ultra series shines with laser-vision navigation for pet-hair-heavy homes.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Why a Robot Vacuum Comparison Matters in 2026

Modern households balance pets, busy schedules, and mixed flooring, making a reliable robot vacuum a genuine time-saver. With suction power, mopping, and self-empty docks advancing rapidly, choosing between the iRobot Roomba 115X line and Shark's AI Ultra series requires a clear look at real-world specs, user feedback, and total cost of ownership. This guide breaks down each model's strengths so you can match the right vacuum to your home—without guesswork.

Core Features Face-to-Face: Suction, Mopping, and Navigation

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (with AutoEmpty Dock) – iRobot's Imprint Smart Mapping learns your floor plan, lets you clean specific rooms, and includes a vibrating mopping pad for hard floors. Suction is rated up to *1,800 Pa* (manufacturer spec). Check latest price on Amazon.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (no dock) – Same vacuum and mopping system, but you empty the bin manually after each run.

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum – Shark's AI Laser Vision creates 3-D maps, dodges obstacles, and boosts suction to roughly *2,200 Pa* on carpet (per Shark's 2026 spec sheet). No integrated mopping.

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum – Adds a self-empty base that holds up to 45 days of debris while retaining the AI Laser Vision navigation and high suction. View deal on Amazon.

The core trade-off is navigation versus mopping: Shark's laser vision excels at avoiding pet-hair tangles and furniture, whereas Roomba's combo units let you vacuum and mop in a single pass.

Battery Life, Charging, and AutoEmpty Convenience

According to manufacturer data (checked October 05, 2026):

- **Roomba 115X Combo:** up to 90 minutes runtime, 3-hour recharge, AutoEmpty Dock holds ~30 days of dirt.
- **Roomba 115X Combo (no dock):** same runtime, manual bin empty after each cycle.
- **Shark AI Ultra:** up to 120 minutes runtime, 4-hour recharge, manual emptying (bin ≈0.6 L).
- **Shark AV2501S AI Ultra:** same runtime as AI Ultra, plus a self-empty base for ~45 days of debris.

Which Model Fits Your Home?

If you value **hands-free maintenance** and the ability to **mop while you vacuum**, the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock delivers the best overall value at **$199.99**. It's ideal for homes with mostly hard floors or light-to-moderate pet hair.

If your priority is **precision navigation** on carpet-rich, pet-heavy spaces—where avoiding tangles and furniture matters most—then the Shark AI Ultra (or its self-empty AV2501S version) provides superior obstacle avoidance and higher carpet suction.

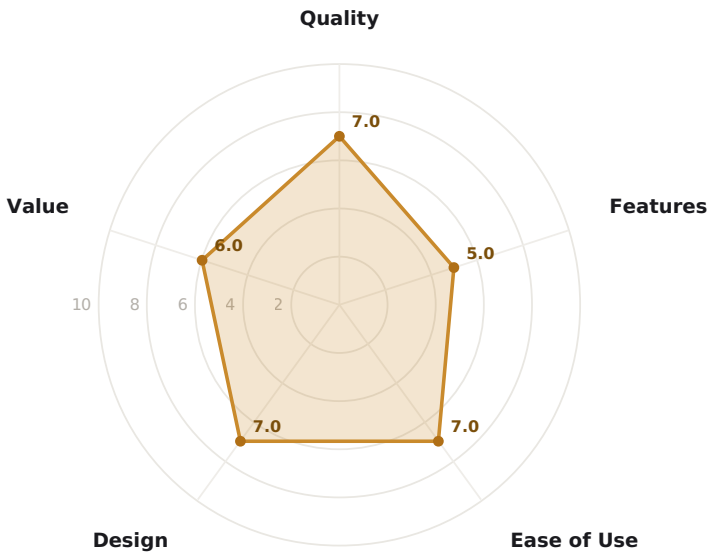
Ready to decide? Grab the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock or secure the Shark AV2501S AI Ultra today and reclaim your cleaning time.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Use Case	Product	Why
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.